

CAROLYN B. ABBOTT

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ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Associate Professor, Department of Political Science, Baruch College – CUNY	2026–present
Assistant Professor, Department of Political Science, Baruch College – CUNY	2021–2026
Assistant Professor, Department of Government and Politics, St. John’s University	2018–2021
Postdoctoral Research Fellow, John Glenn College of Public Affairs & Department of Political Science, The Ohio State University	2016–2018

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Politics and Social Policy, Princeton University	2016
Dissertation: <i>The Politics of Public Sector Pensions</i>	
Committee: Nolan McCarty, Brandice Canes-Wrone, Charles Cameron	
M.A., Politics, Princeton University	2013
B.A., Economics and Political Science, <i>with High Honors</i> , Swarthmore College	2008

PUBLICATIONS

Abbott, Carolyn. (2025). *The Politics of Public Pensions: Parties, State Governments, and Unions*. Columbia University Press.

Abbott, Carolyn, Matthew Incantalupo, and Akheil Singla. (2025). Voter Responsiveness to Measures of Local Government Financial Health. *Urban Affairs Review*, 61(6), pp. 1741–1780.

Rauscher, Emily, Greer Mellon, Susanna Loeb, and **Carolyn Abbott.** (2025). When Money Matters Most: Unpacking the Effectiveness of School Spending. *Sociology of Education*, 98(4), pp. 314–336.

Abbott, Carolyn, Matthew Incantalupo, and Akheil Singla. (2025). Informing Voters about Public Finance: Evidence from a Survey Experiment. *Public Finance Journal*, 2(1), pp. 7–20.

Abbott, Carolyn and Akheil Singla. (2021). Helping or Hurting? The Financial Costs and Benefits of Municipal Bankruptcy. *Public Administration Review*, 81(3), pp. 428–445.

Abbott, Carolyn and Akheil Singla. (2021). Service Solvency and Quality of Life After Municipal Bankruptcy. *Journal of Political Institutions and Political Economy*, 2(2), pp. 249–280.

Abbott, Carolyn and Asya Magazinnik. (2020). At-Large Elections and Minority Representation in Local Government. *American Journal of Political Science*, 64(3), pp. 717–733.

Abbott, Carolyn, Vladimir Kogan, Stéphane Lavertu, and Zachary Peskowitz. (2020). School District Operational Spending and Student Outcomes: Evidence from Tax Elections in Seven States. *Journal of Public Economics*, 183, 104142.

Abbott, Carolyn. (2018). Review of Michael A. McCarthy, *Dismantling Solidarity: Capitalist*

Politics and American Pensions since the New Deal. Political Science Quarterly, 133(2), pp. 371–372.

AVAILABLE WORKING PAPERS

“Do Special Districts File for Bankruptcy in the United States, and Why?” (with Pengju Zhang and Jinah Yoo). **Invited to revise and resubmit**, *Public Budgeting & Finance*.

“Private Money in Public Schools: PTA Inequality and the Accountability Gap in New York City.” **Under review**.

“The Impact of Local Electoral Rules on Government Spending: Evidence from School Districts in California” (with Pengju Zhang). **Under review**.

“The Political Consequences of Local Financial Emergencies” (with Matthew Incantalupo and Akheil Singla).

“Public Responses to Local Fiscal Stress and Distress in the United States” (with Akheil Singla and Pengju Zhang).

“Fiscal Federalism and Local Public Good Provision: Examining the Politics and Impact of the SALT Cap” (with Rahul Pathak).

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

The Uncontested City: Interest Groups, Nonprofits, and Democratic Inequality in One-Party America (book manuscript).

“Parties or Pluralism? Endorsement Competition and Primary Outcomes in One-Party Cities.”

“Analyzing the Impact of Community Boards on Local Governance in New York City.”

GRANTS, AWARDS, AND FELLOWSHIPS

PSC-CUNY Track 1 Research Award, City University of New York	2026 (\$7,000)
ExCEL Faculty-Student Research Award, Baruch College	2026 (\$8,000)
PSC-CUNY Traditional B Research Award, City University of New York	2025 (\$6,000)
Faculty Research Support Award, Baruch College	2025 (\$2,000)
GovFi Prize for Best Paper, <i>Public Finance Journal</i> (with Incantalupo & Singla), GFOA	2025 (\$8,000)
Samuels Center Faculty Fellowship, Baruch College	2024 (\$5,000)
Eugene M. Lang Junior Faculty Research Fellowship Award, Baruch College	2024 (\$8,000)
PSC-CUNY Traditional B Research Award, City University of New York	2024 (\$6,000)
GovFi Research Award (with Incantalupo & Singla), GFOA	2024 (\$1,000)
Artinian Award, Southern Political Science Association	2024 (\$500)
Faculty Fellowship Publication Program, City University of New York	2024
PSC-CUNY Traditional B Research Award, City University of New York	2023 (\$6,000)
Faculty Innovation Seed Grant (with Rahul Pathak), Baruch College	2022 (\$12,000)
PSC-CUNY Traditional B Research Award, City University of New York	2022 (\$6,000)
Grant (with Nolan McCarty), Social and Economic Effects of the Great Recession, Russell Sage Foundation	2012 (\$114,921)

Graduate School Centennial Fellowship, Department of Politics, Princeton University 2010–2015
Honorale Mention, NSF Graduate Research Fellowships Program 2010

INVITED TALKS (SINCE 2021)

“2025 New York City Mayoral Election and Beyond,” panelist, *Baruch College – CUNY* 2025
“Decoding the Role of Parent-Teacher Associations in New York City School Budgets,” *Public Finance and Budgeting Northeastern Workshop, Howard J. Samuels State and City Policy Center, Baruch College – CUNY* 2025
“The Politics of Public Pensions,” keynote, *10th Annual Political Science Reception, Baruch College – CUNY* 2025
“Analyzing the Impact of Community Boards on Local Governance in New York City,” *Eugene M. Lang Junior Faculty Research Fellowships Luncheon, Baruch College – CUNY* 2025
“Informing Voters about Public Finance: Evidence from a Survey Experiment,” *Government Finance Officers Association Webinar* 2025
“Analyzing the Impact of Community Boards on Local Governance in New York City,” *Faculty Research Symposium, Baruch College – CUNY* 2025
“The 2024 Election and the State of American Politics,” moderator, *Baruch College and The Graduate Center – CUNY* 2024
“Analyzing the Impact of Community Boards on Local Governance in New York City,” *Eugene M. Lang New Faculty Fellows Luncheon, Baruch College – CUNY* 2024
“Fiscal Federalism and Local Public Good Provision: Examining the Politics and Impact of the SALT Cap,” *Public Financial Management Northeastern Workshop, Rutgers University – Newark* 2024
“Fiscal Federalism and Local Public Good Provision: Examining the Politics and Impact of the SALT Cap,” *Research in Progress Faculty Seminar, Marxe School of Public and International Affairs, Baruch College – CUNY* 2024
“Voter Responsiveness to Measures of Local Fiscal Performance,” *Spring Public Finance Conference, School of Public Policy, University of Maryland* 2023
“Voter Responsiveness to Measures of Local Fiscal Performance,” *Political Science Research Colloquium, Baruch College – CUNY* 2023
“Fiscal Federalism and Local Public Good Provision: Examining the Politics and Impact of the SALT Cap,” *Annual Faculty Research Symposium, Baruch College – CUNY* 2023
“A Distaste for Deficits: Voter Opinion and Balanced Budget Laws in the U.S. States,” *Research in Progress Faculty Seminar, Marxe School of Public and International Affairs, Baruch College – CUNY* 2021
Roundtable on Capital Assets Reporting Standards, *Governmental Accounting Standards Board (GASB)* 2021
“A Distaste for Deficits: Voter Opinion and Balanced Budget Laws in the U.S. States,” *Public Finance Consortium, School of Public & Environmental Affairs, Indiana University* 2021
“Service Solvency and Quality of Life After Municipal Bankruptcy,” *Local Political Economy Symposium, Bedrosian Center, Sol Price School of Public Policy, University of Southern California* 2021

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

American Political Science Association (2016, 2017, 2022, 2024); Southern Political Science Association (2015, 2016, 2019, 2020, 2021, 2024); Midwest Political Science Association (2015, 2017); Association for Budgeting and Financial Management (2016, 2018, 2022, 2023); Public Management Research Conference (2017, 2023); Association for Public Policy Analysis & Management (2018, 2019); Urban Affairs Association (2019); Brookings Municipal Finance Conference (2020); American Society for Public Administration (2024).

TEACHING

Graduate level: Public Policy, Research Methodology and Quantitative Analysis, State and Local Government and Administration, Public Budgeting and Finance

Undergraduate level: Field Work in Political Science, Public Policy, The Politics of Inequality in the U.S., Introduction to Public Administration, Research Methods for Political Science and Public Administration, Introduction to American Government

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE (SINCE 2021)

- Internship Coordinator & Liaison, Baruch Political Science Department 2025–present
- Senator, Baruch College Faculty Senate 2025–present
- Member, Jessica Plelpi Honors Thesis Committee 2025
- Organizer, Public Finance and Budgeting Northeastern Workshop 2025
- Referee, PSC-CUNY Awards, Economic and Political Science Panel 2024–present
- Member, CUNY Women in American Politics Working Group 2022–present
- Chair, Baruch Political Science Department Colloquium 2022–present
- Member, Baruch Political Science Student Awards Committee 2022, 2024–present
- Member, Baruch Political Science Faculty Peer Observation Committee 2021–present
- Member, Committee to Design the Baruch Public Service Capstone Seminar 2023
- Member, Baruch Political Science Search Committee in Comparative Politics 2021

Referee: American Economic Review: Insights, American Journal of Political Science, American Political Science Review, Applied Economics, Economics & Politics, Economics Letters, European Journal of Political Science, Governance, Journal of Applied Econometrics, Journal of Politics, Journal of Public Administration Research and Theory, Journal of Race, Ethnicity, & Politics, National Tax Journal, Perspectives on Politics, Political Analysis, Political Behavior, Politics & Policy, Public Budgeting & Finance, Public Finance & Management, Russell Sage Foundation, Sage Publications, Southern Economic Journal, Urban Affairs Review.